### Stage I: Developing a sample plan

Definite sequence of steps the interviewer ought to go in order to draw and ultimately arrive at the final sample.

(i) Define the relevant population.

(ii) Obtain a population list, if possible: may only be some type of a sampling frame.

(iii) Fix the sample size

(iv) Choose the appropriate sampling.

(v) Draw the sample.

(vi) Assess the validity of the sample.

(vii) Resample if necessary.

### Stage II: Pilot survey or Pilot Study

It is a guiding survey, usually on a small scale, carried out before the main survey. The information received by pilot survey is utilized in improving the efficiency of the large scale main survey. It helps in:

(i) Estimating the cost of the regular survey

(ii) Correcting the questionnaire of the survey

(iii) Training the field workers.

(iv) Removing the faults of the field organization.

(v) Deciding about the other details of the survey.

### Stage III. Dealing with Non- respondents

Procedures will have to be devised to deal with those who do not give information.

**Points to Remember**

- Data are the ingredients on which statistics works.
- Data type may be primary data or secondary data.
- Source of getting data depends on the problem of study.
- Each method of collection of data has its own advantage and disadvantages. Hence an appropriate method should be used in data collection.
- Studying all individuals in a population is not viable or feasible or impractical, it is advantageous to study the characteristics of the population using sample characteristics.
- In sampling we should specifically specify the population be able to list the sampling frame and use an appropriate sampling method.
- Although several methods are of selecting samples are available, random sampling method is more preferable as it is a representative of the population and have some theoretical advantages.



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